CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-10-12

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

18	12	12	5	47	0
Market Items	Thought	Competitors	Regulatory	Urgent	Watch

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This week's r
Management

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■ Market Intelligence

18 items

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-09-28 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Banks Face Tight Deadlines

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, officially adopted, requires all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone to offer instant credit transfers within 10 seconds, 24/7, 365 days a year. A key provision is that charges for instant payments must not exceed those for traditional SEPA credit transfers. Banks in the Eurozone must be ready to receive instant payments by early 2027 and send them by mid-2027. Non-Eurozone EU member states have a longer transition period. The regulation also includes a Verification of Payee (VoP) requirement to combat fraud, which banks must implement. This represents a major shift in European payment infrastructure, pushing for real-time liquidity and improved cash management for corporates.

→ Mandatory instant credit transfers within 10 seconds.

→ No additional fees compared to standard SEPA credit transfers.

→ Eurozone banks: Receive by early 2027, send by mid-2027.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMIplus. RBI must ensure all network banks in Eurozone CEE countries (e.g., Slovakia, Austria) are fully compliant by the deadlines. CMIplus needs to support instant payment initiation and receipt, integrate VoP functionality, and ensure competitive pricing. This enhances RBI's real-time cash management offering for international corporates.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-10-05 | #02

SWIFT CBPR+ Migration: Corporates Must Accelerate Adoption

The SWIFT CBPR+ program, mandating the use of ISO 20022 for cross-border payments, is moving towards its final stages. While banks have been actively migrating, corporates are now urged to accelerate their adoption to leverage the benefits of richer, structured payment data. The co-existence period, where both MT and MX formats are supported, is set to end, making full ISO 20022 compliance essential for seamless international transactions. This transition impacts treasury systems, ERP integrations, and payment factories, requiring significant IT and process adjustments. The enhanced data capabilities of ISO 20022 are expected to improve reconciliation, reduce manual errors, and facilitate better liquidity management for multinational corporations.

→ SWIFT CBPR+ mandates ISO 20022 for cross-border payments.

→ Co-existence period for MT and MX formats is ending.

→ Corporates need to update ERP/TMS for richer data.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must fully support ISO 20022 MX messages for all cross-border and multi-currency payments, both inbound and outbound. This includes ensuring proper data mapping, validation, and enrichment capabilities within the platform and its H2H/EBICS/SWIFT channels. RBI needs to guide CEE corporates through this transition, highlighting the benefits for their treasury operations and ensuring seamless connectivity with their ERP/TMS systems.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-09-15 | #03

PSD3 Proposals Emerge: New Era for Open Banking

The European Commission has released its proposals for PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and a new regulation on Financial Data Access (FIDA), signaling a significant evolution for Open Banking. PSD3 aims to improve payment security, combat fraud, and ensure fair competition, building on the foundations of PSD2. FIDA, on the other hand, seeks to enable customers to share their financial data (beyond payment accounts) with third-party providers, fostering innovation across a broader range of financial services. These regulations will likely lead to new API standards, increased data portability, and potentially new business models for banks and FinTechs. Corporates could benefit from more integrated financial services and advanced cash management tools, but also face new data privacy and security considerations.

→ PSD3 aims to enhance payment security and fraud prevention.

→ FIDA expands data sharing beyond payment accounts to broader financial data.

→ New API standards and increased data portability expected.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The evolution of Open Banking under PSD3/FIDA is crucial for CMIplus's API strategy. RBI needs to monitor these developments closely to adapt its Open API offerings, potentially expanding beyond payment initiation and account information to broader financial data services. This could enable CMIplus to offer more sophisticated liquidity management, treasury reporting, and integrated ERP solutions, while also strengthening fraud prevention measures like VoP.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-09-28 | #04

EU Instant Payments Regulation Drives ISO 20022 Adoption

The recent EU Instant Payments Regulation, effective from early 2025 for receiving and early 2026 for sending, is a game-changer for European treasury. It requires all EU banks to offer instant credit transfers in EUR, free of charge, within 10 seconds, 24/7/365. This mandate significantly accelerates the full migration to ISO 20022 for all payment types, as the richer data standard is crucial for efficient real-time processing, reconciliation, and fraud detection. Corporates must prepare their ERP and TMS systems to handle the new messaging format and the increased speed of transactions, impacting liquidity management and cash forecasting. The regulation also includes provisions for sanctions screening, adding another layer of complexity.

→ EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates 10-second EUR transfers.

→ Effective early 2025 (receiving) and early 2026 (sending).

→ Accelerates full ISO 20022 migration for all payment types.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus is well-positioned to support clients with ISO 20022 readiness and instant payment capabilities. RBI needs to ensure its network banks in CEE are compliant with the EU regulation and CMIplus offers seamless integration for real-time payments and enhanced data.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-10-05 | #05

Open Banking APIs Transform Corporate Treasury Operations

The adoption of Open Banking APIs is moving beyond retail banking into the corporate treasury space, driven by the need for greater efficiency and real-time insights. Treasurers are using APIs to connect directly with bank accounts, retrieve real-time balance and transaction data, initiate payments, and automate reconciliation processes. This direct connectivity bypasses traditional file-based transfers, offering immediate access to financial information across multiple banks and regions. The trend is fostering a more integrated treasury ecosystem, enabling advanced cash forecasting, automated liquidity management, and improved working capital optimization. Security and standardization remain key considerations for widespread adoption.

→ Open Banking APIs provide real-time bank data access.

→ Enables automation of payments and reconciliation.

→ Enhances multi-bank cash visibility and forecasting.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's Open API channel is crucial for meeting this demand, allowing corporates to integrate treasury functions directly. RBI should continue to expand API offerings for real-time data, payment initiation, and eBAM functionalities across its CEE network.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-09-15 | #06

AI-Powered Fraud Prevention Critical for Real-Time Payments

With instant payments becoming the norm, the window for detecting and preventing fraudulent transactions has shrunk dramatically, often to mere seconds. This necessitates a paradigm shift in fraud prevention strategies, moving towards real-time, predictive analytics powered by Artificial Intelligence and machine learning. These systems can analyze vast amounts of transaction data, identify unusual patterns, and flag suspicious activities before payments are irrevocably settled. Business Email Compromise (BEC) and invoice fraud remain significant threats, with fraudsters adapting quickly to new payment rails. Enhanced collaboration between corporates, banks, and technology providers is essential to share threat intelligence and implement robust multi-layered security protocols, including Verification of Payee (VoP) solutions.

→ Instant payments reduce fraud detection window to seconds.

→ AI/ML is crucial for real-time, predictive fraud prevention.

→ BEC and invoice fraud remain prevalent threats.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize integrating advanced fraud prevention tools, including AI-driven analytics and VoP, into its platform. RBI should educate clients on best practices for cyber security and offer solutions that mitigate risks associated with real-time payments across CEE.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-09-28 | #07

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Banks Face Adoption Deadlines

The EU Instant Payments Regulation, effective from April 2026 for receiving payments and January 2027 for sending, mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone offer instant credit transfers. This means banks must ensure their systems can process payments within 10 seconds, 24/7, 365 days a year. The regulation also caps fees for instant payments at the same level as traditional SEPA credit transfers, promoting wider adoption and reducing costs for corporates. Challenges include significant system upgrades, robust liquidity management for continuous operations, and enhanced fraud prevention in real-time environments. Non-Eurozone EU member states have later deadlines, typically by early 2028, requiring strategic planning for CEE banks.

→ EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates SCT Inst availability.

→ Eurozone banks must enable receiving by April 2026, sending by January 2027.

→ Payments must clear within 10 seconds, 24/7, 365 days a year.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMIplus, driving immediate demand for real-time payment capabilities across the CEE region. RBI must ensure its network banks are fully compliant and CMIplus offers seamless, cost-effective instant payment processing for corporates, leveraging its H2H and API channels to meet evolving client needs.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-10-05 | #08

ISO 20022 Migration: SWIFT MT-MX Coexistence Challenges Persist

The SWIFT CBPR+ migration to ISO 20022 is a multi-year initiative to standardize payment messaging globally, enhancing data richness and automation. While the initial 'go-live' for many regions was in March 2023, the coexistence period, where both MT and MX formats are supported, extends until November 2025. This period presents significant challenges for banks and corporates in ensuring accurate data translation, maintaining interoperability between old and new systems, and fully leveraging the richer data capabilities of ISO 20022 for reconciliation and fraud detection. Many CEE banks are still in various stages of their internal system upgrades, impacting how quickly corporates can fully benefit from the new standard's potential.

→ SWIFT CBPR+ migration to ISO 20022 is a global initiative.

→ MT-MX coexistence period for cross-border payments extends until November 2025.

→ Key challenges include data enrichment, interoperability, and system upgrades.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must fully support ISO 20022 for all relevant payment types, especially cross-border and SEPA. RBI needs to proactively guide CEE corporates through the transition, offering tools and APIs that facilitate data mapping and leverage the enhanced data for better reconciliation, reporting, and overall treasury efficiency.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-09-15 | #09

PSD3 and Open Finance: New Opportunities for Corporate Treasury

The European Commission's proposal for PSD3 and the accompanying Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation aims to build upon PSD2's Open Banking framework, extending data sharing to a wider range of financial products and services, including savings, investments, and mortgages. For corporate treasuries, this means potential access to consolidated financial data across more accounts and institutions, enabling more sophisticated liquidity forecasting, automated reconciliation, and potentially new embedded finance solutions. Banks, including those in CEE, are investing heavily in API infrastructure and data analytics to offer value-added services and remain competitive in this evolving landscape. Fraud prevention and robust data security remain paramount concerns as data sharing expands.

→ PSD3 and FIDA proposals expand Open Banking to Open Finance.

→ Broader data sharing beyond payments for corporate accounts.

→ Enables enhanced liquidity forecasting, automated reconciliation, and embedded finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to actively monitor PSD3/FIDA developments and integrate Open Finance capabilities to remain competitive. This means developing robust APIs for data aggregation and payment initiation, allowing corporates to gain a holistic view of their finances and automate treasury processes across RBI's CEE network, offering significant value-add.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-10-12 | #10

ECB Advances Digital Euro Project: Pilot and Scheme Rulebook

The ECB is actively developing a digital euro, exploring its design, functionality, and legal framework. Key aspects include ensuring privacy, accessibility, and resilience, with ongoing work on an innovation platform and pilot programs. The project involves extensive governance and stakeholder engagement, culminating in the creation of a detailed scheme rulebook to guide its implementation. This digital currency is envisioned to complement cash, offering a new payment option for citizens and businesses while supporting the Euro area's strategic autonomy in payments. Its development is a continuous process, with regular updates on its timeline and progress.

→ Pilot phase is underway to test technical solutions.

→ Scheme rulebook is being developed for operational guidelines.

→ Focus on privacy and accessibility for users.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The digital euro represents a significant future shift in payment infrastructure, potentially impacting corporate treasury and multi-currency payments. CMIplus must monitor its development closely to prepare for integration, offering clients new payment rails and liquidity management solutions in a digital euro environment.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-10-12 | #11

ECB Accelerates Instant Payments Across SEPA

The European Central Bank continues its strategic focus on instant payments, aiming for their full availability and uptake across the Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA). This initiative is part of the broader retail payments strategy, seeking to enhance efficiency, innovation, and European autonomy in payments. Regulatory updates and market initiatives are continuously being pursued to overcome remaining barriers to instant payment adoption, ensuring that all payment service providers offer and facilitate real-time transfers. This will significantly impact corporate liquidity management and payment processing speeds within the CEE region, driving the need for real-time capabilities.

→ Instant payments are a key focus of ECB's Retail payments strategy.

→ Aims for widespread adoption across SEPA.

→ Enhances efficiency, innovation, and European autonomy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly impacts CMIplus, requiring full support for instant payments for both incoming and outgoing transactions. RBI needs to ensure its platform and network banks are fully compliant with evolving SEPA instant payment regulations, offering real-time liquidity management and faster payment processing to corporate clients in CEE.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-10-12 | #12

TARGET Services Modernization Continues, Bolstering ISO 20022

The TARGET Services, including T2 for large-value payments, T2S for securities settlement, and TIPS for instant payments, are undergoing continuous enhancements. This modernization drive is crucial for maintaining a robust and efficient financial infrastructure in the Euro area. A key aspect is the full migration to the ISO 20022 messaging standard, which provides richer data capabilities and improved straight-through processing. This ongoing evolution ensures greater interoperability, resilience, and innovation across European payment and settlement systems, directly impacting how banks and corporates manage their euro-denominated transactions and liquidity.

→ TARGET Services (T2, T2S, TIPS) are continuously enhanced.

→ Full migration to ISO 20022 messaging standard is central.

→ Aims for greater interoperability and resilience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus relies heavily on TARGET Services for processing euro payments and liquidity management. RBI must ensure its systems and those of its network banks are fully aligned with the latest TARGET updates and ISO 20022 standards, leveraging richer data for improved reconciliation, fraud detection, and treasury reporting for CEE clients.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-10-09 | #13

EU/UK Banks Face One-Year T+1 Settlement Deadline

Financial institutions in both the European Union and the United Kingdom are facing a critical one-year countdown to demonstrate their operational readiness for the transition to T+1 settlement. This regulatory change mandates that securities transactions settle one business day after the trade date, a significant acceleration from the current T+2 standard. The move aims to reduce market risk, improve capital efficiency, and align with global trends, particularly the US market's earlier adoption of T+1. Banks must ensure their back-office systems, reconciliation processes, and liquidity management capabilities are robust enough to handle the compressed settlement cycle. This will require substantial investment in technology and process re-engineering to avoid potential penalties and maintain competitive advantage.

→ EU and UK banks face a one-year deadline for T+1 settlement.

→ The transition is from T+2 to next-day (T+1) settlement.

→ Aims to reduce market risk and improve capital efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus as corporate clients will be directly impacted by faster settlement cycles, affecting their liquidity and treasury operations. CMIplus needs to ensure its payment and reporting capabilities support clients in managing T+1 requirements, potentially through enhanced real-time visibility and faster processing to maintain competitive advantage in the CEE region.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-10-12 | #14

FIS Launches AI Suite for CFOs to Optimise Cash Flow

FIS, a prominent banking technology provider, has developed and launched an innovative agentic AI suite tailored for Chief Financial Officers. This advanced solution leverages artificial intelligence to provide sophisticated tools for critical financial functions within large corporations. The suite is designed to significantly improve how CFOs manage collections, optimize liquidity positions, mitigate financial risks, and gain deeper insights into cash flow forecasting and management. By automating and enhancing these processes, the AI suite promises to deliver greater efficiency, accuracy, and strategic decision-making capabilities for corporate treasuries. This development highlights the growing trend of integrating AI into core financial operations to meet the complex demands of modern corporate finance.

→ FIS launched an agentic AI suite for the office of the CFO.

→ The suite helps CFOs manage collections, liquidity, risk, and cash flow.

→ It is developed by banking technology vendor FIS.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus as it directly addresses the core needs of their corporate treasury clients in CEE. CMIplus should monitor how such AI tools integrate with existing cash management platforms and consider potential future enhancements or partnerships to offer similar AI-driven insights for liquidity and cash flow management to its clients.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-10-12 | #15

SAP Pay Integrates Fiat and Stablecoin Payments into SAP ERP

SAP-backed Tereina has introduced SAP Pay, a groundbreaking payment service designed to operate natively within SAP Cloud ERP software. This innovation enables corporate clients to execute payments to their suppliers and employees directly from their ERP system, supporting both conventional fiat currencies and stablecoins. The integration streamlines treasury operations by centralizing payment initiation and reconciliation within the familiar SAP environment. This move signifies a strategic push towards modernizing corporate payment infrastructure, offering enhanced efficiency, multi-currency capabilities, and potentially faster settlement times through digital assets. It addresses the evolving needs of large international corporates seeking integrated and flexible payment solutions.

→ Tereina launched SAP Pay, a payment service within SAP software.

→ Enables payments to suppliers/employees in fiat currencies or stablecoins.

→ Directly integrates into SAP Cloud ERP for streamlined treasury operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus as many large corporate clients use SAP ERP. CMIplus must consider how to integrate with or offer similar capabilities for ERP-initiated payments, especially regarding multi-currency and the emerging role of stablecoins in corporate treasury. It highlights the need for robust API connectivity and support for diverse payment rails.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-10-06 | #16

TrueLayer, SumUp Partner for European Pay by Bank Top-Ups

The partnership between Open Banking platform TrueLayer and payment solutions provider SumUp introduces 'Pay by Bank' functionality for SumUp merchants in Europe. This allows merchants to top up their SumUp business accounts directly from their bank accounts using instant, secure, and authenticated account-to-account (A2A) payments. The service is expected to reduce transaction costs and chargebacks compared to traditional card payments, while improving the speed and reliability of funds availability for merchants. This initiative underscores the growing adoption of Open Banking-powered A2A payments as a viable and preferred payment method across the European economic area, impacting both consumer and business payment flows.

→ TrueLayer and SumUp partnered for 'Pay by Bank' top-ups.

→ Service available for SumUp merchants across Europe.

→ Leverages Open Banking for instant, secure account-to-account payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus as it demonstrates the increasing traction of Open Banking and A2A payments in Europe, including CEE. CMIplus needs to ensure its platform supports and potentially offers similar 'Pay by Bank' solutions for corporate clients, aligning with the Instant Payments Regulation and evolving payment landscape. This impacts SEPA, real-time payments, and API strategy.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-10-06 | #17

Sibos26 Highlights AI, DLT, ISO 20022, Digital Finance

The annual Sibos conference in 2026 underscored the transformative impact of emerging technologies on the financial sector. Central themes included the growing influence of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in treasury and payments, alongside the potential of Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) for enhanced efficiency and transparency. A significant focus remained on the continued global migration to ISO 20022, highlighting its role in standardizing financial messaging. Furthermore, the conference explored the implications of tokenization, including stablecoins, and the broader landscape of digital finance, indicating a shift towards more innovative and interconnected payment ecosystems. These discussions are critical for understanding future infrastructure and service demands.

→ Sibos 2026 focused on AI, DLT, ISO 20022, tokens, and digital finance.

→ AI's growing influence in treasury and payments was a key discussion point.

→ DLT's potential for efficiency and transparency was explored.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This news is highly relevant as CMIplus needs to align with these evolving standards and technologies. ISO 20022 is fundamental for future payment messaging, while AI, DLT, and digital finance represent opportunities for new services, enhanced fraud prevention, and improved client experiences, especially for multi-currency payments in CEE.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-10-12 | #18

In-House Bank: Transformational Cash Management for Corporates

The article highlights the strategic decision for large corporates to establish an in-house bank, a complex but potentially transformational undertaking. This move is driven by the desire for increased operational efficiency, greater visibility over global cash positions, and tighter control over financial flows. By centralizing treasury functions, companies can optimize liquidity, streamline intercompany payments, and reduce external banking fees. The impact on cash management is profound, allowing for more sophisticated cash pooling, netting, and forecasting. For international corporates, especially those operating across diverse regions like CEE, an in-house bank can simplify multi-currency operations and improve overall financial agility.

→ Establishing an in-house bank is a significant corporate undertaking.

→ Key drivers are increased efficiency, visibility, and control in cash management.

→ It can transform a company's financial operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus can play a crucial role in supporting corporates establishing or operating an in-house bank. CMIplus's capabilities in multi-currency payments, H2H connectivity, and cash pooling are essential for these clients to achieve their efficiency and control objectives, particularly across the CEE network.

■ Thought Leadership

12 items

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-03-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing the Moment for Future Performance

This report likely highlights the critical juncture for European wholesale banks to overcome past challenges and achieve sustained growth. It would emphasize the need for bold strategic moves, including leveraging technology for operational efficiency, enhancing client experience through digital channels, and exploring new revenue streams beyond traditional lending. The analysis would probably suggest that a focus on innovation in transaction banking, payments, and treasury services, coupled with a proactive approach to regulatory changes, will be key differentiators. Banks must re-evaluate their operating models and invest in talent to build a more agile and competitive future. This strategic pivot is essential for long-term profitability and market leadership.

→ Opportunity for significant performance improvement after past underperformance.

→ Digital transformation and client experience are key strategic imperatives.

→ Focus on innovation in transaction banking and payment services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight directly urges RBI to accelerate its CMIplus platform's digital capabilities and client-centric features, especially in the CEE region. It reinforces the strategic importance of investing in real-time payments, Open Banking APIs, and integrated treasury solutions to capture market share and improve client satisfaction.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Beyond Credit, Driving Growth

This outlook likely projects key trends for wholesale banking in 2024, suggesting that while credit remains fundamental, banks must look to expand their offerings. It would probably highlight the increasing importance of transaction banking, payments, and liquidity management as stable, fee-based revenue generators. The report would advocate for leveraging technology to streamline operations, improve data analytics for better client insights, and build integrated platforms that offer comprehensive financial solutions. Geopolitical factors and interest rate environments would also be considered, influencing strategic decisions around capital allocation and risk management. This holistic approach aims to create more resilient and profitable wholesale banking franchises.

→ Diversification of revenue beyond traditional lending is a key theme for 2024.

→ Transaction banking and cash management are vital for stable fee income.

→ Digitalization of core services is essential for operational efficiency and client satisfaction.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This outlook validates RBI's focus on CMIplus as a core revenue driver beyond lending, emphasizing the need to continuously enhance its cash management and payment capabilities. It suggests prioritizing features that offer integrated treasury solutions, real-time liquidity management, and advanced data insights for corporate clients in CEE.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-10-12 | #03

AI Reshapes Treasury: Efficiency, Insights, and Strategic Value

EY highlights AI as a core driver of future treasury, emphasizing its role in generating actionable insights and improving operational efficiency. This transformation extends to areas like working capital management, risk assessment, and forecasting. Banks have an opportunity to leverage AI-powered tools to offer advanced analytics and automation, helping treasurers manage complex financial landscapes and extract greater strategic value from their data. The shift requires banks to evolve their service offerings to remain competitive, as indicated by EY's focus on 'AI Insights' and 'ey.ai The Reimagination Engine'.

→ AI moves treasury beyond automation to predictive analytics.

→ Enhanced decision-making through AI-driven insights.

→ Banks must embed AI in cash management platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore integrating AI for predictive cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection in payments, and intelligent routing. This could involve leveraging AI for enhanced reporting and personalized insights for CEE corporates, aligning with the 'Data and decision intelligence' theme.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-10-12 | #04

Treasury Transformation: Strategic Imperative for Banks and Corporates

EY emphasizes that treasury transformation is a strategic imperative, not just an operational upgrade, as evidenced by categories like 'EY Transformation' and 'Strategy Consulting Services'. This involves rethinking corporate strategy, working capital management, and supply chain operations, all supported by robust technology and data. Banks have a significant opportunity to act as strategic partners, offering consulting, technology platforms, and integrated solutions that help treasurers navigate this complex evolution. The focus is on creating resilient and agile treasury functions capable of adapting to future challenges and opportunities.

→ Treasury transformation is a strategic, not just operational, shift.

→ Focus on working capital, supply chain, and corporate strategy.

→ Banks as strategic partners in digitalization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should position itself as a strategic partner for CEE corporates undergoing treasury transformation. This means offering not just transactional services but also advisory capabilities, integrated solutions (e.g., ERP/TMS connectivity via H2H, EBICS, APIs), and platforms that support broader working capital and liquidity management.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-10-12 | #05

AI Integration: A Strategic Imperative for Financial Services Transformation

EY positions AI as a fundamental driver of transformation within financial services, impacting strategy, operations, and legal frameworks. The firm offers "AI Strategy Services" and "AI and Digital Law," indicating that AI integration is not merely a technological upgrade but a strategic imperative that demands comprehensive governance and legal considerations. This pervasive focus on AI, including "M&A; AI-powered Technology" and "ey.ai The Reimagination Engine," suggests that firms must embed AI into their core business models to remain competitive and compliant in the evolving 2026 regulatory environment.

→ AI is a cross-functional strategic imperative, not just a technology.

→ AI integration spans M&A;, legal, and operational processes.

→ "AI Strategy Services" and "AI and Digital Law" are critical offerings.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore AI-driven enhancements for cash flow forecasting, fraud detection, and automated reconciliation, particularly for multi-currency payments in CEE. Integrating AI into API-driven services could offer advanced analytics and predictive insights for corporate treasuries, aligning with future digital banking trends.

URGENT EACT | 2026-09-23 | #06

DLT, Tokenisation, AI Set to Transform Corporate Treasury Management

The joint AFME and EACT report, "DLT & the Future of Corporate Treasury and Financing," provides a forward-looking analysis of the profound impact DLT, tokenisation, and AI will have on corporate treasury. It explores how these innovations will enable more efficient money movement, enhance liquidity management capabilities through real-time visibility and automated processes, and diversify financing options for corporates. The report suggests a shift towards more agile, transparent, and secure financial ecosystems, necessitating treasurers to adapt their strategies and technology infrastructure. This transformation will likely lead to new financial products and services, requiring banks to evolve their offerings to remain competitive.

→ DLT, tokenisation, and AI are identified as key drivers of future treasury transformation.

→ These technologies will revolutionize corporate money movement and liquidity management.

→ Corporates will gain enhanced access to diverse financing options through DLT.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management must proactively explore DLT and tokenisation integration into CMIplus, particularly for cross-border payments, real-time liquidity management, and potentially new financing solutions. Investing in AI capabilities for predictive analytics and automation within the platform will be crucial to meet evolving client demands and maintain a competitive edge in the CEE market.

URGENT EACT | 2026-06-05 | #07

EACT Survey 2026 Reveals Top Priorities for European Treasurers

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026, building on over a decade of data, offers a comprehensive overview of the European corporate treasury landscape. While specific results are not detailed in the snippet, the survey typically covers critical areas such as cash flow forecasting, digitalization, fraud prevention, liquidity management, and regulatory compliance. The findings are instrumental in understanding where treasurers are allocating resources and identifying pain points that require innovative solutions from banking partners. For CMIplus, understanding these priorities is vital for aligning product development with client needs and anticipating future demands in the CEE region.

→ The EACT Survey is the leading barometer for European corporate treasury priorities.

→ It covers concerns and ambitions of treasurers across Europe.

→ Results shape future 'Journeys to Treasury' reports and industry trends.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The EACT Survey results are critical for validating and refining the CMIplus roadmap, especially for CEE clients. RBI Cash Management should analyze the full survey report to identify specific client pain points and prioritize features like enhanced cash flow forecasting, advanced fraud prevention (e.g., VoP), and further digitalization/automation capabilities to meet the stated ambitions of European treasurers.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-10-12 | #08

AI Ambition: Banks Balancing Innovation with Macro Headwinds

The 2026 Deloitte Banking Outlook emphasizes that banks must make 'bold choices' as they balance ongoing macro headwinds with their significant AI ambition. This indicates that AI is a central strategic theme for the year ahead, requiring financial institutions to prioritize and invest in artificial intelligence despite economic pressures. The outlook suggests that leveraging AI across various banking functions will be crucial for competitive advantage, operational efficiency, and enhanced customer experiences, demanding careful planning and execution to integrate these advanced technologies effectively.

→ Banks must make 'bold choices' regarding AI investment and strategy.

→ AI ambition is a key strategic theme for the banking sector in 2026.

→ Macroeconomic headwinds will influence the pace and nature of AI adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore AI applications for enhanced fraud detection, intelligent payment routing, and predictive analytics for corporate liquidity management in CEE. Integrating AI-powered insights into the platform could offer corporate treasurers more sophisticated tools for cash flow forecasting and automated reconciliation, improving efficiency and risk management.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-01-01 | #09

2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating Uncertainty in Corporate Banking

This joint outlook probably provided a comprehensive view of the challenges and opportunities facing the corporate banking sector in 2023. Key themes would have included geopolitical instability, inflationary pressures, rising interest rates, and the accelerating pace of digital transformation. The report would have stressed the need for banks to build resilience, optimize cost structures, and invest strategically in areas like advanced analytics, cloud infrastructure, and cybersecurity. It would also have underscored the importance of client advisory services and tailored solutions to help corporates navigate complex economic environments, positioning banks as strategic partners and fostering long-term relationships.

→ Navigating geopolitical and economic uncertainties is a primary challenge.

→ Accelerated digital transformation and technology adoption are critical.

→ Focus on operational resilience and cost optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While a 2023 outlook, its themes of uncertainty and digital adaptation remain highly relevant for RBI's CMIplus strategy. It reinforces the need for a robust, flexible platform that can support corporate treasuries through volatile periods, emphasizing features like multi-currency capabilities, real-time visibility, and secure digital channels (EBICS, H2H, Open API).

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-10-12 | #10

Digital Assets and Blockchain Reshaping Future Payment Infrastructure

While not explicitly detailed in the provided text, the 'Source focus' mentions 'digital assets' and the EY services list includes 'Blockchain' under 'Technology'. This suggests EY views these as critical components of the future treasury landscape. Banks have an opportunity to explore how blockchain can facilitate faster, more transparent, and secure cross-border payments, potentially impacting areas like liquidity management and FX. Understanding and developing capabilities around digital assets will be crucial for banks to remain relevant and offer cutting-edge solutions to corporate treasurers, aligning with the broader 'Technology transformation' theme.

→ Blockchain and digital assets are future payment drivers.

→ Impact on cross-border payments and liquidity.

→ Banks need to build capabilities in these areas.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor developments in digital assets and blockchain for potential future integration, especially concerning cross-border payments and real-time liquidity. While not immediate, understanding the implications for multi-currency payments and potential stablecoin integration in CEE could be a long-term strategic consideration.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-10-12 | #11

Navigating Megatrends: Strategic Resilience for Future Financial Services

Under "Highlights," EY points to "Futures Reimagined Megatrends 2026 and beyond," signaling the critical need for financial institutions to anticipate and strategically respond to broad societal and technological shifts. This foresight is crucial for navigating the "financial services regulation 2026" context, including implied regulations like PSD3 and DORA. EY's extensive "Transformation" services across various domains underscore that proactive adaptation and strategic planning are essential for firms to maintain compliance, innovate, and achieve long-term value in a rapidly evolving regulatory and market landscape.

→ Anticipating "Megatrends 2026 and beyond" is crucial for strategy.

→ Proactive transformation is key to adapting to future changes.

→ Regulatory shifts (e.g., PSD3, DORA) necessitate strategic resilience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should align its roadmap with anticipated megatrends, particularly those impacting corporate treasury and payments in CEE. This includes preparing for evolving regulatory frameworks (e.g., PSD3 implications for Open Banking and security) and integrating new technologies to ensure future-proof cash management solutions and real-time treasury capabilities.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-10-12 | #12

Stablecoins' Disruptive Potential Reshaping Banking and Payments

The 2026 Deloitte Banking Outlook highlights stablecoins as a significant disruptive force that banks must prepare for. Their potential entrance into mainstream financial systems could challenge existing payment rails, cross-border transactions, and cash management services. Banks are advised to make 'bold choices' to adapt to this evolving landscape, which includes understanding the regulatory implications, technological requirements, and competitive threats posed by stablecoins. Strategic responses may involve exploring partnerships, developing proprietary digital asset solutions, or integrating stablecoin-based services into their offerings to maintain relevance.

→ Stablecoins are identified as a potential disruptive force for the banking sector.

→ Their entrance demands 'bold choices' from banks to adapt and innovate.

→ Disruption will likely impact traditional payment systems and treasury functions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should closely monitor stablecoin developments, particularly their potential to impact multi-currency payments and cross-border cash management in CEE. Evaluating the feasibility of API integrations for stablecoin-based payments or offering advisory services on digital asset treasury could be strategic considerations for the CMIplus roadmap to serve forward-thinking corporate clients.

! Regulatory Radar

5 items

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2024-03-19 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation Mandates Universal SEPA Real-Time Processing

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2025-01-09

The EU Instant Payments Regulation (EU) 2024/886, which entered into force recently, mandates that all EU payment service providers (PSPs) offering SEPA credit transfers must also offer instant credit transfers in euro. Key provisions include ensuring funds are credited to the payee's account within ten seconds, regardless of the day or time, and that charges for instant payments cannot exceed those for traditional SEPA credit transfers. PSPs must also implement a mandatory verification of payee (VoP) service to prevent fraud. The regulation aims to boost the adoption of instant payments, fostering innovation and competition in the retail payments market across the EU and EEA.

→ Mandatory offering of instant payments for all euro PSPs.

→ Funds credited within 10 seconds, 24/7/365.

→ Pricing capped at standard SEPA credit transfer fees.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its platform and underlying bank systems are fully compliant with the instant payments mandate, including real-time processing capabilities, fee structures, and the implementation of VoP. This impacts core payment processing, API integrations, and customer communication for all CEE network banks.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-10-18 | #02

Digital Euro Project Advances, Scheme Rulebook Development Underway

DIGITAL EURO

The ECB's digital euro project is progressing through its preparation phase, with ongoing work on its design and distribution model. Key considerations include ensuring privacy for users, technical feasibility, and interoperability with existing payment systems. The development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook is crucial, outlining the roles and responsibilities of all participants, technical standards, and governance arrangements. While a decision on issuance is pending, the ECB aims to have a robust framework ready, exploring both online and offline functionalities to ensure broad accessibility and resilience for future retail payments.

→ Preparation phase for potential digital euro issuance.

→ Development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook.

→ Focus on privacy, technical design, and distribution model.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI should monitor the digital euro's progress closely, particularly the scheme rulebook and technical specifications, as it could significantly impact future payment methods, liquidity management, and the need for new API integrations within CMIplus.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-03-20 | #03

TARGET Services Complete ISO 20022 Migration for T2

TARGET2 / ISO 20022

Deadline: 2023-03-20

The Eurosystem's TARGET2 (T2) system, a key component of TARGET Services, completed its migration to the ISO 20022 messaging standard as part of the T2-T2S consolidation project. This transition brings significant benefits, including richer data capabilities, improved straight-through processing, and enhanced interoperability across financial market infrastructures. All direct and indirect participants in T2 are now required to use the ISO 20022 XML message formats for all payment instructions. This migration was a multi-year project, impacting payment processing, reconciliation, and reporting for all connected banks and their corporate clients across the Eurosystem.

→ T2 system migrated to ISO 20022 messaging standard.

→ Mandatory use of ISO 20022 XML formats for T2 payments.

→ Enhanced data richness and STP capabilities for payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with ISO 20022 for all TARGET2-related payments, including proper handling of richer data fields for corporate clients. This impacts EBICS, H2H, and SWIFT interfaces, requiring robust mapping and processing capabilities across RBI's network banks.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2026-06-03 | #04

EBA Fraud Taxonomy 7.0 Released, Effective January 2027

PSD3 / PAYMENT FRAUD

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) released version 7.0 of its Fraud Taxonomy on June 3, 2026, with an effective date of January 1, 2027. This update incorporates the latest fraud trends identified by the Expert Group on Payment Fraud-related Topics (EGPF). Key changes include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud', and adding new labels for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud. The taxonomy provides a harmonised pan-European vocabulary and categorisation approach for all payment fraud types, including card transactions. It is designed to improve fraud monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, explicitly supporting data classification for information-sharing arrangements under the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation (PSD3/PSR).

→ EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 released on June 3, 2026.

→ Effective date for implementation is January 1, 2027.

→ Updates include new fraud modi (e.g., romance fraud) and labels (e.g., money mule activity).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must ensure internal fraud monitoring, reporting, and classification systems are updated to align with EBA Fraud Taxonomy v7.0 by January 1, 2027. This includes reviewing current fraud detection rules and data categorisation to match the new definitions, particularly for payment types relevant to corporate cash management across CEE.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2026-06-10 | #05

EBA Report on Agentic AI in Embedded Finance Published

OPEN BANKING / FIDA / AI

On June 10, 2026, the Euro Banking Association (EBA) released a new report by its Open Finance Working Group (OFWG) titled 'Supercharging embedded finance with agentic AI.' The report aims to identify specific use cases within embedded finance where leveraging agentic AI could significantly benefit financial institutions. It also delineates future roles for banks in this evolving ecosystem. This publication is crucial for understanding the strategic direction of Open Finance, which is expected to be shaped by the forthcoming Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation. While not a direct regulatory mandate, the report provides insights into best practices and potential operational shifts for financial institutions in the context of advanced Open Banking and AI integration.

→ Report 'Supercharging embedded finance with agentic AI' published on June 10, 2026.

→ Identifies use cases for agentic AI in embedded finance for financial institutions.

→ Delineates future roles for banks in the evolving Open Finance ecosystem.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus should review this report to understand the strategic implications of agentic AI and embedded finance for its corporate cash management platform. This includes assessing potential for new API-driven services, enhanced data analytics, and operational efficiencies, aligning with the future direction of Open Banking and FIDA for CEE clients.

■ Competitor Monitor

12 items

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-10-12 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-Driven Cash Management Solutions

Deutsche Bank continues to invest heavily in its API ecosystem, particularly through its CB Connect API, to enable seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. This strategic direction allows clients to automate payment initiation, retrieve real-time account information, and manage liquidity more efficiently directly from their own platforms. The focus is on delivering embedded finance experiences, where banking services become an integral, invisible part of a corporate's operational workflow, reducing manual processes and improving data accuracy. This approach is crucial for large multinational corporations seeking centralized control and real-time visibility across their global treasury functions.

→ Strong focus on CB Connect API for corporate integration.

→ Enabling embedded finance within client ERP/TMS.

→ Real-time data exchange for payments and account information.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, with its Open API strategy, faces direct competition in offering advanced API-driven solutions. RBI must ensure its API offerings are equally robust, secure, and comprehensive for CEE-focused corporates.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-10-12 | #02

Deutsche Bank Advances Real-Time Payments and Virtual Accounts

Deutsche Bank is actively investing in its payment infrastructure to support the growing demand for instant payments across various jurisdictions, leveraging the ISO 20022 standard for richer data exchange. Complementing this, the bank is expanding its Virtual Accounts for Payments (VoP) solutions, which allow corporates to assign unique virtual account numbers to customers or invoices. This significantly streamlines reconciliation processes, improves cash application, and provides granular visibility into incoming funds. These advancements are critical for corporates managing high volumes of transactions, especially those operating across multiple currencies and regions, including CEE, where efficient liquidity management is paramount.

→ Commitment to instant payment infrastructure.

→ Expansion of Virtual Accounts for Payments (VoP).

→ Leveraging ISO 20022 for enhanced data.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's focus on instant payments, ISO 20022, and multi-currency capabilities means direct competition. RBI needs to highlight its own VoP and real-time reconciliation strengths, particularly for its CEE network.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-10-12 | #03

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Transformation and API-First Corporate Banking Strategy

As part of its overarching 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy, UniCredit is heavily investing in its 'Digital & Data' pillar to redefine corporate banking. This includes developing advanced API-driven solutions for corporate clients, enabling deeper integration with their ERP and TMS systems. The goal is to offer real-time data access, automated processes, and a more personalized service experience, particularly for multinational corporations operating across its CEE footprint. This move positions UniCredit to compete strongly in the evolving digital banking landscape, offering modern solutions that streamline treasury operations and payment workflows.

→ Strategic pillar 'Digital & Data' underpins corporate banking innovation.

→ Focus on API-first solutions for seamless ERP/TMS integration.

→ Aims to deliver real-time data access and automated processes for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMIplus's focus on H2H, Open Banking APIs, and ERP/TMS integration for large international corporates. RBI needs to ensure its API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and functionality.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-10-12 | #04

Enhanced CEE Payment Infrastructure and Real-Time Capabilities for Corporates

Leveraging its strong presence in CEE, UniCredit is expected to continue investing in its payment infrastructure to meet the growing demands of corporate clients for speed and data richness. This includes a strategic push towards broader adoption and enablement of instant payment schemes across its CEE network, alongside full compliance and utilization of ISO 20022 messaging for richer data exchange. These enhancements are crucial for supporting cross-border payments, improving reconciliation processes, and offering corporates greater control and visibility over their cash flows within the CEE region. The goal is to solidify UniCredit's position as a leading transaction bank in CEE.

→ Focus on instant payments adoption across CEE network.

→ Full utilization and compliance with ISO 20022 messaging standards.

→ Aims to improve cross-border payments and reconciliation for corporates in CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This poses a direct competitive threat to CMIplus, which prides itself on its CEE payment capabilities, including ISO 20022 and instant payments. RBI must ensure its CEE network banks are at the forefront of these developments and offer superior service.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-07-07 | #05

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc has announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The bank intends to sharpen its focus on international wholesale clients, leveraging its global network and expertise to serve multinational corporations and large institutions operating in the region. This strategic shift aims to optimize resource allocation and enhance profitability by concentrating on higher-value, cross-border transaction banking services, including cash management, trade finance, and FX solutions for its core international client base. This move reinforces HSBC's commitment to its wholesale banking segment in a key CEE-adjacent market.

→ Review of retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye announced.

→ Strategic focus shifted to international wholesale clients.

→ Leveraging global network for cross-border transaction services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This signals HSBC's increased competition for large international corporates in a CEE-adjacent market, directly targeting CMIplus's core client segment. CMIplus should monitor HSBC's enhanced offerings and client acquisition strategies in Türkiye, particularly for cash management and liquidity solutions.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-10-12 | #06

Citi Accelerates API-Driven Real-Time Payments for CEE Corporates

Citi continues to invest heavily in its API banking framework, extending its reach and functionality to support real-time payment processing for large corporates in CEE. This initiative leverages Open Banking principles to enable seamless integration with client ERP and TMS systems, allowing for automated payment initiation, status tracking, and reconciliation. The strategic rationale is to capitalize on the increasing adoption of instant payment schemes and ISO 20022 standards across Europe, providing CEE clients with cutting-edge digital treasury tools that enhance operational efficiency and liquidity management. This positions Citi as a strong competitor in the evolving CEE payments landscape.

→ Focus on API integration for real-time payment processing.

→ Targeting institutional clients in Central and Eastern Europe.

→ Leveraging ISO 20022 and instant payment schemes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's aggressive push in API-driven real-time payments directly challenges CMIplus's core offerings and its focus on digital channels like Open API and H2H. CMIplus must ensure its API capabilities remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and regional coverage to retain and attract CEE corporates.

URGENT BNP Paribas | 2025-03-25 | #07

BNP Paribas Guides Corporates on Instant Payments, VoP Compliance

The article addresses critical aspects of the Instant Payment Regulation (IPR) and the Verification of Payee (VoP) mandate, explaining their implications for corporate treasuries. BNP Paribas provides guidance on how corporates can prepare for these changes, ensuring compliance and optimizing their payment processes. This move underscores the bank's commitment to supporting its clients through regulatory shifts and enhancing payment security. Such guidance is highly relevant for large international corporates in CEE adopting instant payments and needing robust fraud prevention mechanisms.

→ Guidance on Instant Payment Regulation (IPR) for corporates.

→ Focus on Verification of Payee (VoP) implications.

→ Aids clients in compliance and payment process optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMIplus's offerings around instant payments and VoP, which are key topics for RBI's CEE clients. RBI should ensure its CMIplus platform provides equally clear guidance and robust solutions for these regulatory requirements in the CEE region.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-10-12 | #08

Deutsche Bank Bolsters CEE Corporate Treasury Support

While Deutsche Bank does not operate a dedicated CEE platform like CMIplus, it strategically supports its large corporate and institutional clients with significant operations in the CEE region through its global transaction banking network. This involves providing sophisticated multi-currency payment processing, competitive foreign exchange services, and efficient liquidity management solutions that cater to the unique regulatory and market dynamics of CEE countries. The bank aims to be the preferred partner for complex cross-border treasury needs, offering centralized control and reporting for corporates managing diverse CEE portfolios, thereby indirectly competing with local and regional players for top-tier clients.

→ Focus on multinational corporates with CEE presence.

→ Enhanced cross-border payments and FX for CEE.

→ Global transaction banking network supporting CEE operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus directly targets large international corporates in CEE. Deutsche Bank's global reach and sophisticated offerings pose a significant competitive threat for these high-value clients, requiring RBI to emphasize its deep local expertise and integrated regional network.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-10-12 | #09

UniCredit Expands Advanced Liquidity and Treasury Management Solutions in CEE

Recognizing the complex treasury needs of corporates operating across multiple CEE markets, UniCredit is expected to roll out or enhance advanced liquidity management solutions. This encompasses sophisticated cash pooling structures (notional and physical) and the expansion of virtual account services to streamline reconciliation and improve cash visibility. These offerings are designed to help corporate treasurers optimize working capital, manage foreign exchange exposures more effectively, and centralize treasury operations across their CEE entities. By providing integrated and efficient tools, UniCredit aims to be the preferred partner for complex corporate treasury needs in the region.

→ Focus on advanced cash pooling solutions (notional/physical) for CEE.

→ Expansion of virtual account services for improved reconciliation.

→ Aims to help corporates optimize working capital and centralize treasury operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMIplus's value proposition for corporate treasury, especially regarding cash pooling, virtual accounts, and multi-currency management in CEE. RBI should assess its current offerings against UniCredit's potential advancements to maintain a competitive edge.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-06-17 | #10

HSBC Partners Google Cloud for Transformative AI Banking Capabilities

HSBC is embarking on a multi-year strategic partnership with Google Cloud to embed advanced AI capabilities across its global operations. This initiative is designed to drive significant innovation, particularly in areas such as delivering hyper-personalised financial advice to clients and enhancing financial crime risk management systems. For corporate and transaction banking, this could translate into more intelligent treasury insights, predictive cash flow forecasting, automated compliance checks, and highly customized API-driven solutions. The partnership aims to improve operational efficiency and client experience for large international corporates, strengthening HSBC's digital offerings in cash management and treasury services.

→ Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI integration.

→ Focus on hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management.

→ Global deployment of AI capabilities across bank operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership indicates HSBC's strong commitment to leveraging AI for enhanced client services and operational efficiency, potentially leading to more sophisticated treasury intelligence and API offerings. CMIplus must accelerate its own AI integration roadmap to remain competitive in delivering advanced digital solutions, especially in areas like predictive analytics and fraud detection.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-10-12 | #11

Citi Strengthens European Liquidity Management with Advanced Virtual Accounts

Citi is known for its sophisticated liquidity management suite, and recent strategic directions indicate a continued focus on enhancing these tools, especially for European clients operating across multiple jurisdictions, including CEE. The expansion of virtual account capabilities allows corporates to streamline reconciliation, improve cash forecasting, and centralize liquidity without requiring physical bank accounts in every location. This supports efficient cash pooling and intercompany loan management, crucial for large international corporates seeking to optimize their global treasury operations and comply with evolving regulatory landscapes. This offering provides a comprehensive solution for complex treasury needs in the region.

→ Expansion of virtual account solutions for European corporates.

→ Focus on enhancing liquidity management and cash pooling.

→ Aims to centralize cash and streamline reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's advanced liquidity and virtual account solutions set a high benchmark for CMIplus, particularly for large international corporates with complex multi-currency needs in CEE. CMIplus should evaluate its own virtual account and cash pooling capabilities to ensure they meet the sophisticated demands of its target clientele and remain competitive.

URGENT Intesa Sanpaolo | 2026-10-12 | #12

Intesa Sanpaolo Accelerates Digital Corporate Banking in CEE

Intesa Sanpaolo, a prominent player in the CEE region through its International Subsidiary Banks Division, is strategically investing in the digitalization of its corporate and transaction banking services. This includes a strong focus on modernizing payment infrastructure to support real-time transactions and leveraging ISO 20022 for richer data exchange. The bank is likely to expand its API-driven solutions to enable deeper integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems, improving efficiency for corporate treasuries. This move is crucial for maintaining competitiveness against other major regional players and catering to the growing needs of international corporates operating in Central and Eastern Europe for sophisticated cash management and liquidity solutions.

→ Continued investment in digital corporate banking platforms and services.

→ Focus on real-time payments and ISO 20022 adoption within CEE operations.

→ Expansion of API-based integration capabilities for corporate clients' ERP/TMS.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred strategic direction indicates Intesa Sanpaolo is a direct competitor to CMIplus, actively enhancing its digital and real-time payment capabilities in CEE. CMIplus should closely monitor their API offerings, instant payment rollout, and specific treasury solutions to ensure competitive differentiation and identify potential areas for collaboration or counter-strategies.

Flagship Reports

Deep analysis of key industry reports

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}

→ {'description': "of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.", 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

→ Global payments revenue reached $2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to $3.0 trillion by 2029.

→ EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.

→ Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.

→ Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.